

instantly feel on-brand for Skullcandy. It has most of the essential features one would need, but then there are some notable omissions.

You can see the battery status, change volume, noise modes (ANC, transparency), equaliser modes, enable game mode, multipoint pairing, and change button controls. You also get Spotify Tap and camera shutter controls, which some may find useful. I appreciate the customisability of touch gesture controls.

Of course, the app isn't without its flaws, though. It occasionally detects earbuds from other brands as available devices, the battery percentage isn't always accurate, the EQ presets don't make a meaningful difference to the listening experience, and there's no option to disable in-ear wear detection.

ANC AND CALLS

Method 360's ANC sufficiently blocks constant low-frequency sounds, such as the sound of a fan, AC, chimney, etc. You can still hear sudden noises and nearby conversations, albeit at a low volume.

Transparency mode is good enough for quick conversations without taking the earbuds off. However, your own voice sounds bass-heavy and distant, making conversations feel less natural than they should.

During regular voice calls, the other person sounded clear to me, but they consistently said that my voice sounded distant, as if I were speaking from farther away.

BATTERY LIFE

Skullcandy has equipped the Method 360 ANC with an above-average battery life of 8 hours 15 minutes with continuous music playback (FLAC) with AAC codec, 80% volume and ANC on. But the battery life between the two earbuds was constantly inconsistent.



As per the brand, the Method 360 can last for 9 hours and with the case, up to 32 hours with ANC on, and with ANC off, the battery life can last up to 11 hours with the earbuds and up to 40 hours with the case.

So, the runtime in our test was a tad shorter than the brand's claims, but that could be due to different testing conditions. Your mileage may vary based on your listening preferences.

You get fast charging speed, which is said to give 2 hours' worth of playback with just 10-minutes of top-up. Nice. That said, the absence of wireless charging will be missed by some at this price point.

VERDICT

The Skullcandy Method 360 ANC is a product that dares to stand out with a distinctive charging case. With that

and the 'Sound by Bose' branding, Skullcandy is trying to differentiate itself from the sea of earbuds under Rs 13000. Well, if you're after something that starts conversations and offers a decent fit, you'll like this.

However, the overall experience feels less compelling when viewed against similarly priced alternatives. The bulky case isn't the most practical for everyday use, the app needs polishing, transparency mode and call quality leave room for improvement, and the sound doesn't deliver the refinement the Bose partnership leads you to expect. While the battery life is respectable, the lack of wireless charging is another omission at this price. At a lower price, some of these compromises would be easier to overlook.

At Rs 12499, the Method 360 ANC competes in a crowded segment where several rivals offer a more well-rounded experience. So, if you are someone who wants distinctive-looking earbuds with a secure fit, customisable controls, and an easy-going sound, you may still find the Method 360 appealing. But

if sound quality and overall refinement are your priorities, it's worth comparing the Skullcandy earbuds with alternatives before making a decision.

– G S Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Connection type: Bluetooth 5.3 | Impedance: 16 Ohm | Driver Diameter: 12mm | Sound pressure: 97.1 ± 4dB | Frequency Response: 20 - 20K Hz | Mics: 4 | IP Rating: IPX4 | Battery life (ANC On, earbuds and case): 9 and 23 Hrs | Battery life (ANC Off, earbuds and case): 11 and 29 Hrs

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